Internal Summary: MAS Notice 626 AML/CFT Obligations

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1. About this summary

This is an internal, plain-language summary of the main anti-money-laundering and countering-the-financing-of-terrorism (AML/CFT) obligations for banks that Aspire applies to its own programme, based on MAS Notice 626. It is not legal text and does not replace the Notice itself; Legal Counsel should be consulted on interpretation. Aspire uses the Notice as a reference standard for its policies.

2. Risk assessment

• Identify and assess ML/TF risks by customer, country, product, channel and transaction type.

• Document the assessment, keep it up to date and approve it at senior management level at least annually.

• Apply mitigating controls proportionate to the risks identified.

3. Customer due diligence

Identify and verify customers and their beneficial owners before establishing the business relationship, using reliable and independent sources. Beneficial owners are natural persons with ultimate ownership or control; Aspire uses a 25 percent ownership threshold. Understand the purpose and intended nature of the relationship. Apply enhanced measures to higher-risk customers, including politically exposed persons, with senior management approval and source-of-funds checks.

4. Ongoing monitoring

• Scrutinise transactions throughout the relationship for consistency with knowledge of the customer.

• Periodically refresh customer information; Aspire reviews high-risk customers every 6 months and others annually.

• Pay special attention to complex, unusually large or unusual patterns without apparent purpose.

5. Screening

Screen customers, beneficial owners and payment counterparties against sanctions and terrorist designation lists. Matches must be escalated and, where appropriate, assets frozen and reported.

6. Suspicious transaction reporting

Establish internal procedures so that staff report suspicion promptly to a designated officer, who decides whether to file an STR. Aspire's internal standard is a filing within 24 hours of determination. Staff must not tip off customers.

7. Record keeping

Keep CDD information and transaction records for at least 5 years after the end of the relationship or completion of the transaction, in a form that allows reconstruction of individual transactions.

8. Governance, training and audit

Area	Internal application at Aspire
Senior management oversight	MLRO reports monthly to the Risk Committee
Compliance function	Head of Compliance and MLRO, independent from business lines
Training	Annual mandatory compliance training, deadline 30 November
Independent audit	Internal Audit tests the AML programme annually
Group-wide programme	Policies apply equally to Singapore, Ho Chi Minh City and Jakarta teams

9. Where to find detail

See the KYC/AML Policy v3.0 for tiers of due diligence, the Sanctions Screening Procedure for matching rules and the STR Filing Guideline for reporting steps. Questions may be raised with the Compliance team through SupportDesk.